Chapter One

Nature is simple. We do not know why, but she is. When we look at a falling apple and at the Moon going around the Earth, we find the same law at work, and that is the whole surprise of mechanics as it was understood three centuries ago.

So let us start with something concrete. Take a ball on a string and swing it around. What holds it in? The string pulls. Now cut the string and watch the ball fly off along a straight line.